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Global Best Practice



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Glossary

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acceptance criteria

A list of minimum requirements that a service or service component must meet for it to be acceptable to key stakeholders.

agentic AI

AI systems that are designed to act on behalf of users by autonomously performing predefined tasks within agreed boundaries, while remaining subject to human oversight and governance.

AI governance

The system by which an organization directs, controls, and monitors the use of artificial intelligence to ensure that AI-enabled digital products and services create value while remaining ethical, secure, compliant, and aligned with organizational objectives.

AI maturity

The extent to which an organization is able to effectively, responsibly, and consistently use AI capabilities to support its objectives, including governance, data quality, skills, processes, and ethical considerations.

architecture management practice

The practice of providing an understanding of all the different elements that make up an organization and how those elements relate to one another.

architecture principles

A set of norms and rules for the use and deployment of all resources and assets across an organization.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

The capability of digital systems to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as learning from data, recognizing patterns, making predictions, or supporting decision-making.

asset register

A database or list of assets, capturing key attributes such as ownership and financial value.

availability

The ability of an IT service or other configuration item to perform its agreed function when required.

availability management practice

The practice of ensuring that services deliver agreed levels of availability to meet the needs of customers and users.

band of visibility

The sum of the aspects of the service consumer organizations visible to the service provider, and the aspects of the service provider organizations visible to the service consumer.

baseline

A report or metric that serves as a starting point against which progress or change can be assessed.

Behaviour-Driven Development (BDD)

A software development method that emphasizes behaviour that is meaningful to stakeholders rather than low-level unit functionality. For example, instead of writing tests in a programmer-centric language, BDD encourages the use of a ubiquitous, domain-specific language (DSL) that can be read and understood by developers, QA engineers, product owners, and even non-technical business analysts.

best practice

A way of working that has been proven to be successful by multiple organizations.

big data

The use of very large volumes of structured and unstructured data from a variety of sources to gain new insights.

business analysis practice

The practice of analysing a business or some element of a business, defining its needs and recommending solutions to address these needs and/or solve a business problem, and create value for stakeholders.

business case

A justification for expenditure of organizational resources, providing information about costs, benefits, options, risks, and issues.

Business Impact Analysis (BIA)

A key activity in the practice of service continuity management that identifies vital business functions and their dependencies.

Business Relationship Manager (BRM)

A role responsible for maintaining good relationships with one or more internal customers.

capability

The ability of an organization, person, process, application, configuration item, or IT service to carry out an activity.

capacity and performance management practice

The practice of ensuring that services achieve agreed and expected performance levels, satisfying current and future demand in a cost-effective way.

change

The addition, modification, or removal of anything that could have a direct or indirect effect on products and services.

change authority

A person or group responsible for authorizing a change.

change enablement practice

The practice of ensuring that risks are properly assessed, authorizing changes to proceed and managing a change schedule in order to maximize the number of successful service and product changes.

change model

A repeatable approach to the management of a particular type of change.

change schedule

A calendar that shows planned and historical changes.

Change-Data-Capture (CDC)

A method that tracks every change in the source database so that related systems can stay up to date almost instantly. It enables real-time data replication with minimal performance impact and ensures that each change is processed once. This approach is widely used for analytics, microservice communication, and database migrations.

cloud computing

A model for enabling on-demand network access to a shared pool of configurable computing resources that can be rapidly provided with minimal management effort or provider interaction.

complexity thinking

An approach to analysis and decision-making based on the recognition and understanding of the various levels of complexity inherent in the systems and the context in which they operate.

compliance

The act and result of ensuring that a standard or set of guidelines is followed, or that proper, consistent accounting or other practices are being employed.

confidentiality

A security objective that ensures information is not made available or disclosed to unauthorized entities.

configuration

An arrangement of Configuration Items (CIs) or other resources that work together to deliver a product or service. Can also be used to describe the parameter settings for one or more CIs.

Configuration Item (CI)

Any product, service, or component that is within scope of the configuration management practice. Configuration items typically include hardware, software, networks, buildings, suppliers, products, services, and documentation.

Configuration Management Database (CMDB)

A database used to store configuration records throughout their lifecycle. The CMDB also maintains the relationships between configuration records.

Configuration Management System (CMS)

A set of tools, data, and information that is used to support service configuration management.

configuration record

A record containing the details of a Configuration Item (CI). Each configuration record documents the lifecycle of a single CI. Configuration records are stored in a configuration management database.

Content Delivery Network (CDN)

A distributed system of servers strategically placed around the globe to deliver web content, such as HTML pages, images, videos, scripts, and other assets, to end users quickly and reliably.

continual improvement

A recurring organizational activity performed at all levels of an organization to ensure that the organization continually meets stakeholders' expectations.

continual improvement practice

The practice of aligning an organization's practices and services with changing business needs through the ongoing identification and improvement of all elements involved in the effective management of products and services.

continuous delivery

A set of techniques and tools that enables software updates to be deployed to production at any time. Frequent deployments are possible, but deployment decisions are taken case by case, usually because organizations prefer a slower rate of deployment.

continuous deployment

A set of techniques and tools that enables every change that passes automated tests to be automatically deployed to production without additional authorization. Continuous deployment relies on continuous delivery.

continuous integration

A set of techniques and tools that enables developers to frequently merge their code changes into a central repository, followed by automated builds and tests.

core value stream

A value stream that enables value for consumers in a form intended by the organization's operating model.

cost

The amount of money spent on a specific activity, resource, product or service.

cost centre

A business unit or project to which costs are assigned.

Critical Success Factor (CSF)

A necessary precondition for the achievement of intended results.

culture

A set of values shared by a group of people, expressed through people's behaviour and their ideas, beliefs, and practices.

customer

The role that defines the requirements for products and services and takes responsibility for the outcomes of service consumption.

Customer Experience (CX)

The sum of functional and emotional interactions with a service and service provider as perceived by a service customer.

cycle time

The time it takes to complete one specific step of the value stream

dashboard

A real-time graphical representation of data.

data governance

A system of rules, policies, standards, processes, and controls organizations implement to manage their data assets effectively.

deliver and support

The value chain activity that ensures services are delivered and supported according to agreed specifications and stakeholders' expectations.

deployment

The movement of any service component into a controlled environment.

deployment management practice

The practice of moving new or changed hardware, software, documentation, processes, or any other service component to one of the controlled environments.

design thinking

A practical and human-centred approach used by product and service designers to solve complex problems and find practical and creative solutions that meet the needs of an organization and its customers.

development environment

An environment used to create or modify IT services or applications.

DevOps

A cultural and professional movement that stresses communication, collaboration, and integration between software developers and IT operations professionals, while automating the process of software delivery and infrastructure changes. It aims at establishing a culture and environment where building, testing, and releasing software, can happen rapidly, frequently, and more reliably.

digital product

A combination of an organization's resources based on digital technology and designed to offer value to consumers.

digital product and service management

A set of specialized organizational capabilities for enabling value for customers in the form of digital products and services.

digital product vendor

An organization responsible for the creation and continual improvement of digital products and related service offerings.

digital service

A service that fully or largely relies on digital products.

digital transformation

The strategic adoption and integration of digital technologies into all areas of an organization, fundamentally changing how the organization operates and creates value for customers and other stakeholders.

disaster

A sudden unplanned event that causes great damage or serious loss to an organization. A disaster results in an organization failing to provide critical business functions for some predetermined minimum period of time.

disaster recovery plans

A set of clearly defined plans related to how an organization will recover from a disaster as well as return to a pre-disaster condition, considering the four dimensions of product and service management.

effectiveness

A measure of whether the objectives of a practice, service, or activity have been achieved.

efficiency

A measure of whether the right amount of resources have been used by a practice, service, or activity.

enabling value stream

A value stream that enables value for internal customers to support the organization's core value streams.

environment

A subset of the IT infrastructure that is used for a particular purpose, for example a live environment or test environment. Can also mean the external conditions that influence or affect something.

error

A flaw or vulnerability that may cause incidents.

escalation

The act of sharing awareness or transferring ownership of a work item.

event

Any change of state that has significance for the management of a service or other configuration item.

event-driven function

A small, self-contained piece of code that is automatically invoked in response to a specific event rather than being run continuously or called directly by a client. These enable reactive architectures such as micro-service pipelines, real-time data processing, and API back-ends that react instantly to user actions while keeping operational overhead and cost low.

Experience Level Agreement (XLA)

A documented agreement between a service provider and a customer that identifies the agreed experience level for a service.

external customer

A customer who works for an organization other than the service provider.

Extract-Load-Transform (ELT)

An approach to moving data from operational sources into a form suitable for analysis. Extract: retrieve data from the source. Load: immediately store the raw data in the target system (often a modern cloud data lake or massively parallel processing warehouse). Transform: perform the transformation inside the destination environment, leveraging its compute power (e.g., SQL-based transformations or built-in warehouse functions).

Extract-Transform-Load (ETL)

An approach to moving data from operational sources into a form suitable for analysis. Extract: pull raw data from source systems (databases, APIs, files, etc.). Transform: clean, enrich, aggregate, or otherwise reshape the data so it fits the target schema and business rules. This step often includes validation, deduplication, type conversion, and

calculations. Load: write the transformed data into the destination system, typically a data warehouse or analytics platform. The choice between ELT and ETL depends on architecture, performance requirements, and the capabilities of the storage platform.

feedback

Information about stakeholder reactions and opinions, which is used as a basis for improvement.

feedback loop

A term commonly used to refer to a situation where part of the output of an activity is used for new input.

flow efficiency

A metric that indicates the percentage of cycle time (or value-added time) in the lead time.

Generative AI (GenAI)

AI systems that can create new content, such as text, images, code, or other outputs, based on patterns learned from existing data.

goods

Tangible resources that are transferred or available for transfer from a service provider to a service consumer, together with ownership and associated rights and responsibilities.

governance

The system by which an organization is directed and controlled.

governance of digital technology

A human-based system by which the current and future use of digital technology is governed. The system comprises directing, overseeing and accountability.

incident

An unplanned interruption to a service or reduction in the quality of a service.

incident management practice

The practice of minimizing the negative impact of incidents by restoring normal service operation as quickly as possible.

information and technology

One of the four dimensions of product and service management. It addresses data, information, and technologies used in digital products and services, as well as those used as part of the organization's product and service management systems.

information security management practice

The practice of protecting an organization by understanding and managing risks to the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information.

information security policy

The policy that governs an organization's approach to information security management.

infrastructure and platform management practice

The practice of overseeing the infrastructure and platforms used by an organization. This enables the monitoring of technology solutions available, including solutions from third parties.

Infrastructure as Code (IaC)

Infrastructure (servers, networks, storage, etc.) is provisioned and managed using machine-readable configuration files or scripts, rather than manual setup.

integrity (system)

A security objective that ensures information is only modified by authorized personnel and activities.

internal customer

A customer who works for the same organization as the service provider.

Internet of Things (IoT)

A network of physical devices embedded with sensors, software, and other technologies that enable them to connect and exchange data with other devices and systems over the internet or other communication networks.

interoperability

The ability of computer systems or software from different vendors to operate together, and exchange and make use of information.

IT asset

Any financially valuable component that can contribute to the delivery of an IT product or service.

IT asset management practice

The practice of planning and managing the full lifecycle of all IT assets.

IT infrastructure

All of the hardware, software, networks, and facilities that are required to develop, test, deliver, monitor, manage, and support IT services.

ITIL

A framework and best-practice guidance for digital product and service management.

ITIL Continual Improvement Model (ITIL CIM)

A model which provides organizations with a structured approach to planning and implementing improvements.

ITIL Four Dimensions of Product and Service Management

The four perspectives that are critical to the effective and efficient facilitation of value for customers and other stakeholders in the form of products and services.

ITIL Guiding Principles

Recommendations that can guide an organization in all circumstances, regardless of changes in its goals, strategies, type of work, or management structure.

ITIL Value System (ITIL VS)

A model representing how all the components and activities of an organization work together to facilitate value creation through digital products and services.

Kanban

A method for visualizing work, identifying potential blockages and resource conflicts, and managing work in progress.

Key Performance Indicator (KPI)

An important metric used to evaluate the success in meeting an objective.

knowledge management practice

The practice of maintaining and improving the effective, efficient, and convenient use of information and knowledge across an organization.

known error

A problem that has been analysed but has not been resolved.

lead time

The total time from initiation of the value stream workflow to delivery of the intended outputs.

Lean

An approach that focuses on improving workflows by maximizing value through the elimination of waste.

lifecycle

The full set of stages, transitions, and associated statuses in the life of a service, product, practice, or other entity.

live

Refers to a service or other configuration item operating in the live environment.

live environment

A controlled environment used in the operation of digital products and delivery of digital services to service consumers.

maintainability

The ease with which a service or other entity can be repaired or modified.

major incident

An incident with significant business impact that requires an immediate coordinated resolution.

management practice

A set of organizational resources and capabilities designed and adopted for performing work or accomplishing an objective.

management system

A system of interconnected elements that establish policy and objectives and enable the achievement of those objectives.

maturity

A measure of the reliability, efficiency, and effectiveness of an organization, practice, or process.

measurement and reporting practice

The practice of supporting good decision-making and continual improvement by decreasing levels of uncertainty.

metric

A measurement or calculation that is monitored or reported for management and improvement.

Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

A product with just enough features to satisfy early customers, and to provide feedback for future product development.

mission

A short but complete description of the overall purpose and intentions of an organization.

model

A representation of a system, practice, process, service, or other entity that is used to understand and predict its behaviour and relationships.

modelling

The activity of creating, maintaining, and utilizing models.

monitoring

Repeated observation of a system, practice, process, service, or other entity to detect events and to ensure that the current status is known.

monitoring and event management practice

The practice of systematically observing services and service components, and recording and reporting selected changes of state identified as events.

negative testing

A type of testing that validates that a feature or function works as expected with invalid or unexpected inputs.

non-functional testing

A type of testing that validates how a system performs rather than what it does.

observability

The ability to understand the internal state of a complicated system by analysing its external outputs, such as metrics, logs, and traces.

operating model

A conceptual and/or visual representation of how an organization co-creates value with its customers and other stakeholders, as well as how the organization runs itself.

operation

The routine running and management of an activity, product, service, or other configuration item.

operational technology

The hardware and software solutions that detect or cause changes in physical processes through direct monitoring and/or control of physical devices such as valves, pumps, and so on.

organization

A person or a group of people that has its own functions with responsibilities, authorities, and relationships to achieve its objectives.

organization's purpose

Describes what an organization does for its consumers and other stakeholders and why.

organizational change management practice

The practice of ensuring that changes in an organization are smoothly and successfully implemented and that lasting benefits are achieved by managing the human aspects of the changes.

organizational resilience

The ability of an organization to anticipate, prepare for, respond to, and adapt to unplanned external influences.

organizational velocity

The speed, effectiveness, and efficiency with which an organization operates. Organizational velocity influences time to market, quality, safety, costs, and risks.

organizations and people

One of the four dimensions of product and service management. It ensures that the way an organization is structured and managed, as well as its roles, responsibilities, and systems of authority and communication, is well defined and supports its overall strategy and operating model.

outcome

A result for a stakeholder enabled by one or more outputs.

output

A tangible or intangible deliverable of an activity.

outsourcing

The process of having external suppliers provide products and services that were previously provided internally.

partners and suppliers

One of the four dimensions of product and service management. It encompasses the relationships an organization has with other organizations that are involved in the design, development, deployment, delivery, support, and/or continual improvement of services.

partnership

A relationship between two organizations that involves working closely together to achieve common goals and objectives.

performance

A measure of what is achieved or delivered by a system, person, team, practice, or service.

pilot

A test implementation of a service with a limited scope in a live environment.

policy

Formally documented management expectations and intentions, used to direct decisions and activities.

portfolio management practice

The practice of ensuring that an organization has the right mix of programmes, projects, products, and services to execute its strategy within its funding and resource constraints.

positive testing

A type of testing that validates that a feature or function works as expected with valid and correct inputs.

problem

A cause, or potential cause, of one or more incidents.

problem management practice

The practice of reducing the likelihood and impact of incidents by identifying actual and potential causes of incidents, and managing workarounds and known errors.

procedure

A documented way to carry out an activity or a process.

process

A set of interrelated or interacting activities that transform inputs into outputs. Processes define the sequence of activities and their dependencies.

product

A configuration of an organization's resources designed to offer value for a consumer.

product and service portfolio

A complete set of products and services that are managed throughout their lifecycles by an organization.

product/service prototype

An initial version of a product or service that demonstrates its basic form, functionality, and operational capabilities. It is used to test and refine the product's or service's design and functionality and test hypotheses. Prototypes vary in complexity and purpose, ranging from visual mockups to fully functional models.

product/service specification

A detailed document that outlines critical aspects, requirements, and characteristics of a product or service to be built. It typically includes descriptions of the product's features, functionalities, technical requirements, performance criteria, and user interface details.

production environment

See live environment.

programme

A set of related projects and activities, and an organization structure created to direct and oversee them.

project

A temporary structure that is created for the purpose of delivering one or more business products according to an agreed business case.

project management practice

The practice of ensuring that all an organization's projects are successfully delivered.

quick win

An improvement that is expected to provide a return on investment in a short period of time with relatively small cost and effort.

record

A document stating results achieved and providing evidence of activities performed.

recovery

The activity of returning a configuration item to normal operation after a failure.

regression testing

A type of testing that validates code changes have not negatively affected existing functionality.

relationship management practice

The practice of establishing and nurturing links between an organization and its stakeholders at strategic and tactical levels.

release

A version of a product, service, or other configuration item, or a collection of configuration items, made available for use.

release management practice

The practice of making new and changed services and features available for use.

reliability

The ability of a product, service, or other configuration item to perform its intended function for a specified period of time or number of cycles.

request catalogue

A view of the service catalogue, providing details on service requests for existing and new services, which is made available for the user.

Request for Change (RfC)

A description of a proposed change submitted by a stakeholder.

resolution

The action of solving an incident or problem.

resource

Personnel, material, finance, or other entity that is required for the execution of an activity or the achievement of an objective. Resources used by an organization may be owned by the organization or used according to an agreement with the resource owner.

retire

The act of permanently withdrawing a product, service, or other configuration item from use.

risk

A possible event that could cause harm or loss, or make it more difficult to achieve objectives.

risk assessment

An activity to identify, analyse, and evaluate risks.

risk management practice

The practice of ensuring that an organization understands and effectively handles risks.

safety culture

An organizational culture in which people are comfortable being (and expressing) themselves.

service

A means of enabling value co-creation by facilitating outcomes that consumers want to achieve, without the consumer having to manage specific costs and risks.

service action

An action performed by a service provider or jointly by a service provider and a service consumer.

service architecture

A view of all the services provided by an organization. It includes interactions between the services, and service models that describe the structure and dynamics of each service.

service catalogue

Structured information about all the services and service offerings of a service provider, relevant for a specific target audience.

service catalogue management practice

The practice of providing a single source of consistent information on all services and service offerings, and ensuring that it is available to the relevant audience.

service configuration management practice

The practice of ensuring that accurate and reliable information about the configuration of services, and the configuration items that support them, is available when and where needed.

service consumer

An organization responsible for procurement and use of services.

service consumption

Activities performed by an organization to consume services. It includes the management of the consumer's resources needed to use the service, service actions performed by users, and the receiving (acquiring) of goods (if required).

service continuity management practice

The practice of ensuring that service availability and performance are maintained at a sufficient level in case of a disaster.

service design practice

The practice of designing products and services that are fit for purpose, fit for use, and that can be delivered by the organization and its ecosystem.

service desk practice

The practice of providing the entry point and single point of contact with the service provider for all users, and capturing demand for incident resolution and service requests.

service experience

The sum of the functional and emotional interactions with a service and provider as perceived by a stakeholder.

service financial management practice

The practice of supporting an organization's strategies and plans for service management by ensuring that the organization's financial resources and investments are being used effectively.

service journey

The sum of activities and interactions performed by organizations engaged in service relationships to fulfil their roles as a service provider and a service consumer.

service level

A set of metrics that define expected or achieved service quality.

Service Level Agreement (SLA)

A documented agreement between a service provider and a customer that identifies the services provided and the agreed level of each service.

service level management practice

The practice of setting clear business-based targets for service performance so that the delivery of a service can be properly assessed, monitored, and managed against these targets.

service offering

A formal description of one or more services designed to address the needs of a target consumer group. A service offering may include goods, access to resources, and service actions.

service provider

An organization responsible for delivery and support of services.

service provision

Activities performed by an organization to provide services. It includes management of the provider's resources configured to deliver the service; ensuring access to these resources for users; fulfilment of the agreed service actions; service level management; and continual improvement. It may also include the supply of goods.

service quality

The sum of the characteristics of a service that are relevant to its ability to satisfy stated and implied needs.

service relationship

A cooperation between a service provider and service consumer. Service relationships include service provision, service consumption, and service relationship management.

service relationship management

Joint activities performed by a service provider and a service consumer to ensure continual value co-creation based on agreed and available service offerings.

service request

A request from a user or a user's authorized representative that initiates a service action which has been agreed as a normal part of service delivery.

service request management practice

The practice of supporting the agreed quality of a service by handling all pre-defined, user-initiated service requests in an effective and user-friendly manner.

service validation and testing practice

The practice of ensuring that new or changed products and services meet defined requirements.

service value

The perceived benefits, usefulness, and importance of a service

Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

A discipline that incorporates aspects of software engineering and applies them to infrastructure and operations problems. The main goal is to create scalable and highly reliable software systems.

software development and management practice

The practice of ensuring that applications meet stakeholder needs in terms of functionality, reliability, maintainability, compliance, and auditability.

sourcing

The activity of planning and obtaining resources from a particular source type, which could be internal or external, centralized or distributed, and open or proprietary.

specification

A documented description of the properties of a product, service, or other configuration item.

sponsor

The role that authorizes budget for service consumption.

sprint

A fixed timeframe (typically of 2–4 weeks) for creating selected features from the backlog.

stakeholder

A person or organization that has an interest or involvement in an organization, product, service, practice, or other entity.

standard

A document established by consensus and approved by a recognized body that provides, for common and repeated use, mandatory requirements, guidelines, or characteristics for its subject.

standard change

A low-risk, pre-authorized change that is well understood and fully documented and which can be implemented without needing additional authorization.

status

A description of the specific states an entity can have at a given time.

strategy management practice

The practice of formulating the goals of an organization and adopting the courses of action and allocation of resources necessary for achieving those goals.

supplier

An organization responsible for supplying goods and providing services that are used by another organization.

supplier management practice

The practice of ensuring that an organization's suppliers and their performance levels are managed appropriately to support the provision of seamless quality products and services.

support team

A team with the responsibility to maintain normal operations, address users' requests, and resolve incidents and problems related to specified products, services, or other configuration items.

sustainability

The assurance that a product or service meets and will continue to meet the requirements for environmental stewardship, social progress, and economic growth.

swarming

A technique for solving various complex tasks. In swarming, multiple people with different areas of expertise work together on a task until it becomes clear which competencies are the most relevant and needed.

system

A combination of interacting elements organized and maintained to achieve one or more stated purposes.

systems thinking

A holistic approach to analysis that focuses on the way that a system's constituent parts work, interrelate, and interact over time and within the context of other systems.

technical debt

The implied cost of additional rework caused by choosing an easy solution now instead of a better approach that would take longer.

test environment

A controlled environment established to test products, services, and other configuration items.

Test-Driven Development (TDD)

A software development method where the developer writes a failing automated test before writing the production code it's meant to verify. It follows a Red-Green-Refactor loop: write a failing test (Red), write just enough code to make it pass (Green), then clean up the code (Refactor).

testing

The activity in which a system or component is executed under specified conditions, the results are observed or recorded, and an evaluation of some aspect or component of the system is made.

third party

A stakeholder external to an organization.

throughput

A measure of the amount of work performed by a product, service, or other system over a given period of time.

transaction

A unit of work consisting of an exchange between two or more participants or systems.

use case

A realistic practical scenario used to define functional requirements and to design tests.

user

The role that uses services.

User Experience (UX)

The sum of the functional and emotional interactions with a service and service provider as perceived by a service user.

user query

An interaction (for example, a telephone call or a chat) with the service desk, initiated by a user or user representative. A user query could result in an incident or a service request being logged.

utility

The functionality offered by a product or service to meet a particular need. Utility can be summarized as 'what the service does' and can be used to determine whether a service is 'fit for purpose'. To have utility, a service must either support the performance of the consumer or remove constraints from the consumer. Many services do both.

utility requirements

Functional requirements which have been defined by the customer and are unique to a specific product.

validation

The activity of confirming that the proposed product and service design meets agreed requirements and establishing acceptance criteria for the next lifecycle stages.

value

The perceived benefits, usefulness, and importance of something.

value chain

An entire set of activities that enables value through the provision of a product or service.

value chain activities

Activities performed by organizations to manage digital products and services through their lifecycle. Each of these activities is enabled and supported by several management practices.

value stream

A series of steps that an organization uses to create and deliver products and services to a service consumer.

value streams and processes

One of the four dimensions of service management. It defines the activities, workflows, controls, and procedures needed to achieve the agreed objectives.

vision

A defined aspiration of what an organization would like to become in the future.

wait time

The time spent waiting between the value stream steps.

warranty

The assurance that a product or service will meet the agreed requirements. Warranty can be summarized as 'how the service performs' and can be used to determine whether a service is 'fit for use'. Warranty often relates to service levels aligned with the needs of service consumers. This may be based on a formal agreement, or it may be a marketing message or brand image. Warranty typically addresses such areas as the availability of the service, its capacity, levels of security, and continuity. A service may be said to provide acceptable assurance, or 'warranty', if all defined and agreed conditions are met.

warranty requirements

Typically non-functional requirements captured as inputs from key stakeholders and other practices.

workaround

A solution that reduces or eliminates the impact of an incident or problem for which a full resolution is not yet available. Some workarounds reduce the likelihood of incidents.

workforce and talent management practice

The practice of ensuring that an organization has the right people with the appropriate skills and knowledge and in the correct roles to support its business objectives.

Notes

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Notes

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